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December 22, 2025

Search Committee
The Broad Center
Yale School of Management
New Haven, CT

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Postdoctoral Research Associate position at The Broad Center at Yale School of Management. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research focuses on macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and inequality, with an emphasis on how heterogeneity in economic environments shapes long-run outcomes and policy effectiveness.

My research agenda centers on understanding the determinants of inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth affects aggregate outcomes. In my job market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and embed these estimates in a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the observed distribution of wealth, providing a tractable framework for connecting micro-level dispersion to macroeconomic inequality and long-run economic mobility.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on work documenting a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for realized returns to wealth. This project highlights a behavioral channel through which social attitudes and beliefs shape economic outcomes, and it provides new estimates of persistent differences in returns that have implications for lifetime resource accumulation.

I am particularly interested in the Broad Center postdoctoral associateship because of its focus on management, governance, and leadership in public education, and its commitment to improving outcomes for students from historically underserved communities. While my core training is in economics, my research speaks directly to questions of inequality, persistence, and opportunity that are central to education policy. The tools I use to study long-run wealth accumulation, belief formation, and heterogeneous returns are naturally applicable to understanding disparities in educational environments, school quality, and the effectiveness of institutional interventions over the life course.

The structure of the associateship is especially appealing to me. The opportunity to devote substantial time to my own research while also collaborating closely with affiliated faculty aligns well with my goal of expanding my work toward questions at the intersection of economics, education, and

institutional design.

Beyond research fit, I am drawn to The Broad Center's mission of translating rigorous scholarship into practice and preparing leaders who can improve public education systems. I value research environments that encourage engagement with policymakers and practitioners, and I see this associateship as an ideal setting in which to deepen the policy relevance of my work while developing new collaborative projects that meaningfully inform educational practice.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration. I would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss my application further.

Sincerely,

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